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Gear for a wannabe YouTuber

Agent001 comes to the rescue as another friend falls for the photography bug



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Esports is huge and it's growing in India. I've been following quite a few teams and streamers for quite some time. And of late, some of my friends have fallen prey to the esports bug. Even if they don't play a particular game, they'll still watch the stream because they like the person who's streaming. While I'm not a fan of PewDiePie but I do follow a few streamers like QuickyBaby, The Mighty Jingles and 2mgovercsquared and I get the appeal. I understand why gamers are drawn towards such streams and I've contemplated streaming a few games myself. Alas, doing that might disclose a secret that has been guarded for ages – my identity. xD

So earlier last month, I was chilling with a couple of friends when I got a Twitch Notification indicating that Jingles had gone live. I promptly fire up my machine and started watching the stream. Soon enough one of my mates decided that watching other people play games was juvenile and started taking my case. Yes, even I'm prone to getting my leg pulled once in awhile. I

ignored the ribbing till he realised he wasn't going to get a rise out of me and then sat down to watch the stream along with me. Fortunately, he too played World of Tanks and was soon taken in by the stream. Watching a really good player take out half the enemy squad even when the odds are stacked against them does make for an exciting game to watch. Exciting enough to have someone completely new to livestreaming remain glued to the screen. But that didn't stop him from spewing snarky comments. Even though the players on the stream were significantly better skilled, my friend would find some fault or the other, after all you can just do a complete turnaround from being a jerk to an ardent fan in under an hour.

A week down the line I saw that very friend share a Facebook post of a game stream and soon enough, he too caught the live streaming bug. In fact, I'd get a WhatsApp message soon after a stream got over and he'd be dying to discuss some of the best moves or the stupidest moments from the stream. The addiction soon got the better of him and his conversation soon moved to how he'd do it if he were to stream. Yeah, everyone's a backseat driver.

So I called him out with the age old dialogue, "Kar ke dikha!". And to my surprise, he took it upon himself to start his own YouTube channel. Pulling off a live stream is not an easy task so the first step was to get comfortable with doing videos and getting them out in a timely manner, hence, YouTube. And so began his hunt for equipment.

Making videos for YouTube is easy, you have numerous free screen capture software and video editing software to help make quality videos. All that's left is to record a voice over and then upload to YouTube. He already had a pretty decent PC so all that was left was the microphone and webcam. He tried using the embedded microphone on the SoundMagic E10M but didn't find the audio quality up to mark. It made him sound completely weird so he went and got the Blue Yeti USB microphone. They're a bit expensive for someone starting out but the sound captured is quite similar to source and you have the option to switch polar patterns between cardioid, stereo, omni and bidirectional modes.

What was left was the webcam and that's where he ended up getting a little confused. Confused enough to call me